

**The figurative censer, incense, &
pot Symbols related to sacrifice, prayer, &
worship**

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The figurative censor

- Censer = vessel for burning incense typically used in religious worship and prayer
- If the figurative fire represents God's word of judgment, then the censer is the place we put that fire, our hearts.



Let them construct a sanctuary for Me, that I may dwell among them. According to all that I am going to show you, as the pattern of the tabernacle and the pattern of all its furniture,

just so you shall construct it. (Ex 25:8-9)

... who serve a copy and shadow of the heavenly things, just as Moses was warned by God when he was about to erect the tabernacle; for, “See,” He says,

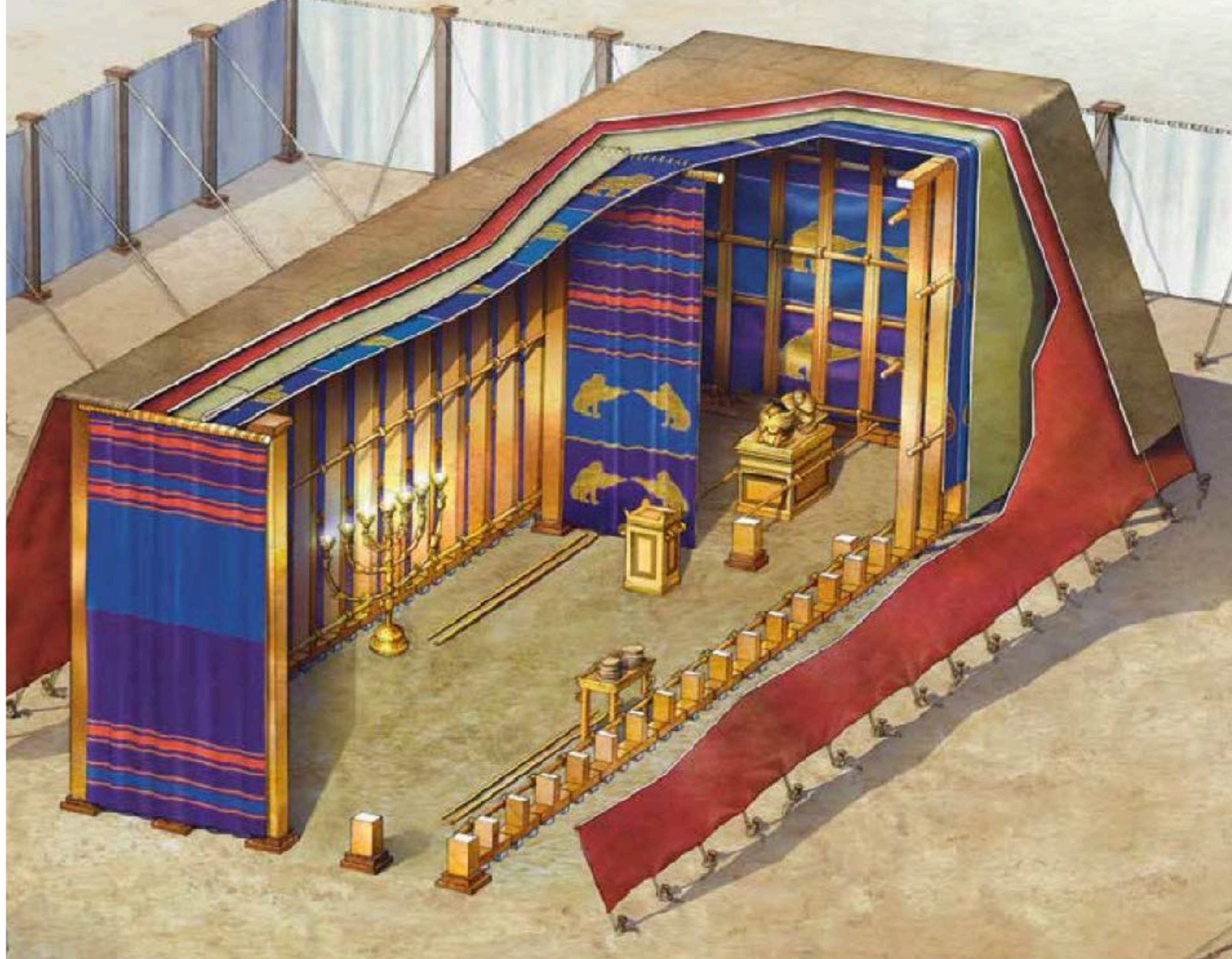
**“that you make all things according to the pattern
which was shown you on the mountain.” (Heb 8:5)**

God’s tabernacle in the wilderness • A tent Moses built according to

God’s commands (Ex 25-27) with
two rooms: Holy Place and Most
Holy Place.

of manna, Aaron’s rod that
budded, & the stone tablets of the

- Tabernacle’s furnishings:
lampstand, table of consecrated
bread, altar of incense, ark of the
covenant containing a golden jar



time. Accordingly both gifts and sacrifices are offered which cannot make the worshiper perfect in conscience, since they relate only to food and drink and various washings, regulations for the body imposed until a time of reformation. (Heb 9:9-10)

which is a symbol for the present covenant (Heb 9:1-10).

Proper use of the censer was life or

death

- The high priest, who represented all of Israel, was responsible for preparing and carrying the lit censer from the HP to the MHP to meet God.
- *He shall take a firepan full of coals of fire from upon the altar before the Lord and two handfuls of finely ground sweet incense, and bring it inside the veil. He shall put the incense on the fire before the Lord, that the cloud of incense may cover the mercy seat that is on the ark of the testimony, otherwise he will die. (Lv 16:12-13)*

Changes in worship methods

- OT: ritual sacrifice, etc.
- NT: worship in song/word, prayers
- *For I delight in loyalty rather than sacrifice, and in the knowledge of God rather than burnt offerings. (Hos 6:6)*

incense,



- *May my prayer be counted as incense before You; the lifting up of my hands as the evening offering. (Ps 141:2)*

Prayers & worship acceptable to God

- Does God hear every prayer?
- Does God answer every prayer?
- Is there a right and a wrong way to pray?

- What about worship? Is there a right way to worship?
- These things were hidden in the OT tabernacle and its censer.

The figurative incense and smoke

- Censer = heart of a believer

- Incense = prayers (Ps 141:2, **Rv 5:8**)
- Smoke = prayers lifted to God (Rv 8:3-4)
- *Another angel came and stood*

at the altar, holding a golden censer; and much incense was given to him, so that he might add it to the prayers of all the saints on the golden altar which was before the throne. And the smoke of the incense,



s,

**When He
had taken**

went up before God out of the angel's hand. (Rv 8:3-4)

**Prayer & worship
unacceptable to God**

**the book, the four living creatures
and the twenty four elders fell down
before the Lamb, each one holding a
harp and golden bowls full of
incense, which are the prayers of the
saints. (Rv 5:8)**

- God does not receive or even listen to the prayers of those who are not His (**Is 1:15**, **Is 16:12**, **Lv 10:1-2**, **Prv 15:8**, **Prv 15:29**).

- *So when you spread out your hands in prayer, I will hide My eyes from you; Yes, even though you multiply prayers, I will not listen. Your hands are covered with blood. (Is 1:15)*



- *The Lord is far from the wicked, but He hears the prayer of the righteous. (Prv 15:29)*

Prayer & worship acceptable to God

- *If **you** abide in Me, and **My words** abide in you, **ask whatever you wish**, and it will be done for you. (Jn 15:7)*
- If you are God's **censer** filled with **God's**



fire, then the incense of your prayers will be lifted up to God as smoke and He will hear them.

- *God is spirit, and those who worship Him must worship in spirit and truth. (Jn 4:24)*

Therefore I urge you, brethren, by the mercies of God, to present your bodies a living and holy sacrifice, acceptable to God, which is your spiritual service of worship. And do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind, so that you may

prove what the will of God is, that which is good and acceptable and perfect. For through the grace given to me I say to everyone among you not to think more highly of himself than he ought to think; but to think so as to have sound judgment, as God has allotted to each a measure of faith.

Rom 12:1-3

The figurative cooking pot

- Just as both the figurative field and tree can represent one person or many, a large

vessel like a cooking pot is used to represent an organization of people like a church.

- *‘The time is not near to build houses. This city is the pot and we are the flesh.’ Therefore, prophesy against them, son of man, prophesy!”*
(Ez 11:3-4)
- See also God’s judgment of the rusty/
rebellious cooking pot of Israel in Ez 24:3-6.

And I said, “Hear now, heads of Jacob and rulers of the house of Israel. Is it not for you to know justice? You who hate good and love evil, who tear off their skin from them

and their flesh from their bones, who eat the flesh of my people, strip off their skin from them, break their bones and chop them up as for the pot and as meat in a kettle ... Her leaders pronounce judgment for a bribe, her priests

instruct for a price and her prophets divine for money. Yet they lean on the Lord saying, “Is not the Lord in our midst? Calamity will not come upon us.”

Mic 3:1-3, 11

In that day there will be inscribed on the bells of the horses, “HOLY TO THE LORD.” And the cooking pots in the Lord’s house will be like the bowls before the altar. Every cooking pot in Jerusalem and in Judah will be holy to the Lord of hosts; and all who sacrifice will come and take of them and boil in them. And there will no longer be a Canaanite in the house of the Lord of hosts in that day.

Zec 14:20-21

Cleaning the cooking pots

- The first time Jesus came 2,000 years ago, he came to clean out the encrusted cooking pots (synagogues) of Israel.
- The time of the second coming is a time to clean out the encrusted cooking pots (churches) of Christianity.
- *For it is time for judgment to begin with the household of God; and if it begins with us first, what will be the outcome for those who do not obey the gospel of God? And if it is with difficulty that the righteous is saved, what will become of the godless man and the sinner? (1 Pt 4:17-18)*

**These things I have spoken to you
so that you may be kept from
stumbling. They will make you
outcasts from the synagogue, but
an hour is coming for
everyone who kills you to think
that he is offering service to**

God.

Jn 16:1-2

**“Blessed are those who have been
persecuted for the sake of righteousness,
for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.
Blessed are you when people insult you
and persecute you, and falsely say all
kinds of evil against you because of Me.**

Rejoice and be glad, for your reward in heaven is great; for in the same way they persecuted the prophets who were before you.

Mt 5:10-12

Summary and conclusion

- As people who want to worship God in "spirit and truth," we learned that those who fill the censer of their hearts with the fire of God's word can offer up incense and smoke (prayers) acceptable to God.
- We also learned that the pot represents synagogues/
Smoke = Prayers rising to God

churches and when those pots become encrusted with impurities they cannot make something God will find acceptable.

- Both the first and 2nd comings are times of cleansing the pots to make them holy to God ... but its only those who accept the

word revealed at that time who can be cleansed. And rather than going gently, those who reject it and refuse to be cleansed will become Satan's vessels who persecute those who accept it and remain God's people.



Fire = Word

Censer = heart Incense = prayers

Let's pray 